



This Start-Up Is More Something Than Nothing

Nothing: 不可小觑的新秀

难度评级: ★★★★★

【 Para.1 】

Artificial intelligence has **upended** Wall Street, **Main Street**, and every road in between. In Silicon Valley, **venture** capital dollars are **rushing** to find AI targets, with total venture funding **surging** to \$256 billion in the first quarter of 2026, according to PitchBook, **surpassing** the 2025 total.

人工智能彻底颠覆了华尔街、普通民众的生活以及两者之间的方方面面。据PitchBook数据显示，在硅谷，风险投资资金正蜂拥而至，争相寻找人工智能领域的投资标的，2026年第一季度的风险投资总额飙升至2560亿美元，超过了2025年的全年总额。

【 Para.2 】

As with public markets, those AI dollars have **crowded out** other investments, including the once **red-hot** area of

文章导读：

大量风投资金涌入人工智能行业，消费科技领域因而受到影响。智能手机的全能和激烈竞争也是一大原因。而一家新公司仅凭一部手机成为热门新秀。Nothing这家公司业绩飞升，互联网讨论热度也颇高。其优势之一在于后指显示屏，简洁化手机通知。该公司也获得了大额融资。而这类公司也容易昙花一现，例如Fitbit和GoPro。但风投者似乎并不介意，总是积极寻找下一个热门项目。Nothing有其独特优势，但也面临一些挑战。

upend v. If you upend something, you turn it upside down. 颠倒【考研大纲词汇】

He **upended** the beer, and swallowed.
他把啤酒倒出来，大口喝了。

Main Street n. [U] typical middle-class Americans 典型的美国中产阶级

Main Street won't be happy with this new program.
中产阶级不会对这个新计划感到高兴的。

venture n. A venture is a project or activity that is new, exciting, and difficult because it involves the risk of failure. 风险项目；冒险活动【考研大纲词汇】

...a Russian-American joint **venture**.
...一个俄美合资的风险项目。

rush v.~(sb) (into sth/into doing sth) to do sth or to make sb do sth without thinking about it carefully (使) 仓促行事，匆忙行事，做事草率【考研大纲词汇】

We don't want to **rush** into having a baby.
我们不急着要孩子。

surge v. (of prices, profits, etc. 物价、利润等) to suddenly increase in value 急剧上升；飞涨；激增【考研大纲词汇】.

Share prices **surged**. 股价猛涨。

surpass v. /sə'pɑ:s/ (formal) to do or be better than sb/sth 超过；胜过；优于【考研大纲词汇】

He hopes one day to **surpass** the world record.
他希望有一天能刷新世界纪录。

crowd out v. to fill a place so that other people or things are kept out 把 (其他人或物) 排挤在外

red hot a. (informal) new, exciting and of great interest to people 热门的

a **red-hot** issue 热点问题

slide v. ~ (from...) (to...) to become gradually lower or of less value 逐渐降低；贬值【考研大纲词汇】

Shares **slid** to a 10-year low. 股价跌到了10年来的最低点。

consumer tech. After peaking near 3,000 in 2021, the number of VC deals for consumer tech was cut in half by last year, PitchBook data show, and the figure continues to **slide** in 2026.

与公开市场一样，这些流向人工智能的资金挤占了其他投资领域，包括曾经炙手可热的消费科技领域。

PitchBook数据显示，消费科技领域的风险投资交易数量在2021年达到近3,000笔的峰值后，到去年已减半，且这一数字在2026年仍在持续下滑。

【 Para.3 】

Blame the decline on the do-everything smartphone, which fills in as a camera, GPS, digital assistant, calculator, and all **sorts** of other products that once filled the **aisles** of an electronics shop. Jeff Barrington, managing director at Windsor Drake, tells Barron's that building a consumer tech start-up is **incredibly** challenging. Margins are low, supply challenges are vast, and competition is fierce. "The other thing, too, is that the big Apples, Amazons, and Googles tend to copy or absorb the consumer tech products," he says.

这一下滑应归咎于当下几乎全能的智能手机——它集相机、GPS、数字助理、计算器以及其他各类产品于一身；而这些产品曾一度填满了电子产品的货架。温莎·德雷克（Windsor Drake）董事总经理杰夫·巴灵顿（Jeff Barrington）告诉《巴伦周刊》，创办一家消费科技初创企业极具挑战性。利润率低、供应链问题重重，且竞争异常激烈。“此外，像苹果、亚马逊和谷歌这样的大型企业往往会模仿或收购消费科技产品，”他说。

sort n. a group or type of people or things that are similar in a particular way 种类；类别；品种【考研大纲词汇】

SYN kind

'What sort of music do you like?' 'Oh, all **sorts**.'

“你喜欢哪一类音乐？” “噢，哪一类都喜欢。”

aisle n. /aɪl/ a passage between rows of seats in a church, theatre, train, etc., or between rows of shelves in a supermarket (教堂、戏院、火车等座位间或超级市场货架间的) 走道，过道【考研大纲词汇】

an **aisle** seat (= in a plane)

(飞机上) 紧靠过道的座位

incredibly adv. /ɪnˈkredəbli/ extremely 极端地；极其

SYN unbelievably

incredibly lucky/stupid/difficult/beautiful

极其幸运/愚蠢/困难/美丽

take on v. If you take someone on, you fight them or compete against them, especially when they are bigger or more powerful than you are. 与（尤指强于自己的人）较量

Democrats were reluctant to **take on** a president whose popularity ratings were historically high. 民主党不愿意与一个支持率创历史新高的总统较量。

earbud n. a small earphone worn in the ear for use with a mobile phone (配合手机等使用的) 耳塞

aesthetic n. /iːsˈθetɪk/ The aesthetic of a work of art is its aesthetic quality. (艺术品的) 审美特质【考研大纲词汇】

He responded very strongly to the **aesthetic** of this particular work.

他对这部作品的审美特质反应十分强烈。

break away phrase to leave a political party, state, etc., especially to form a new one 脱离，背叛（政党、国家等，尤指再组建新的）【考研大纲词汇】

The people of the province wished to **break away** and form a new state.

该省人民希望分离成立一个新国家。

undercut v. to sell goods or services at a lower price than your competitors 削（价）竞争；以低于（竞争对手）的价格做生意

to **undercut** sb's prices

以低于对手的价格求售

comparable a. /ˈkɒmpərəbl/ ~ (to/with sb/sth) similar to sb/sth else and able to be compared 类似的；可比较的【考研大纲词汇】

A **comparable** house in the south of the city would cost twice as much.

一栋类似的房子位于城南部就要贵一倍的价钱。

garner v. /ˈgɑːnə(r)/ (formal) to obtain or collect sth such as information, support, etc. 获得，得到，收集（信息、支持等）

SYN gather acquire

【 Para.4 】

That history makes it all the more surprising that one of this year's hottest consumer tech start-ups is **taking on** the establishment with...a phone. Nothing, founded in 2020, began as an **earbud** maker before moving into smartphones and smartwatches. The products have a clean and modern **aesthetic** that has attracted a young audience looking to **break away** from tech giants Apple and Samsung Electronics. Its prices often **undercut** the competition. The Nothing 4a Pro phone with 256GB of storage starts at \$599; a **comparable** iPhone17 goes for \$799..

鉴于这一背景，今年最热门的消费科技初创公司之一竟仅凭.....一部手机向行业巨头发起挑战，更令人惊讶。成立于2020年的Nothing最初是一家入耳式耳机制造商，随后进军智能手机和智能手表领域。其产品拥有简洁现代的美学设计，吸引了希望摆脱苹果和三星电子等科技巨头束缚的年轻用户群体。且其定价往往低于竞争对手。配备256GB存储空间的Nothing 4a Pro手机起价为599美元；而配置相当的iPhone 17售价为799美元。

【 Para.5 】

The company, which didn't make executives available for interview, crossed \$1 billion in lifetime sales in 2024. Nothing has **garnered** a lot of social-media attention, with Google trends for "Nothing Phone" and "Nothing headphones" both up 500% versus the previous five years.

该公司其累计销售额于2024年突破10亿美元大关，但未安排任何高管接受采访。Nothing在社交媒体上引发

gloat v. /gləʊt/ ~ (about/at/over sth) to show that you are happy about your own success or sb else's failure, in an unpleasant way 扬扬得意；沾沾自喜；幸灾乐祸

SYN crow

She was still **gloating** over her rival's disappointment.
她仍在为对手的失望而幸灾乐祸。

behemoth n. /'bi:hɪməθ/ (formal) a very big and powerful company or organization 巨头（指规模庞大、实力雄厚的公司或机构）

commoditize v. =commodify to treat (something) inappropriately as if it can be acquired or marketed like other commodities 使商品化

rear a. /rɪə(r)/ [only before noun] at or near the back of sth 后面的；后部的【考研大纲词汇】

front and rear windows 前面和后面的窗户

facedown adv. 面向下地

go n. an attempt at doing sth （做某事的）尝试，一番努力【考研大纲词汇】

It took three **goes** to get it right. 试了三次才把它弄好。

saga n. a long series of events or adventures and/or a report about them 一连串的事件（或经历）；一连串经历的讲述（或记述）

The front page is devoted to the continuing **saga** of the hijack. 头版是对劫持事件的连续报道。

eat into v. to use up a part of sth, especially sb's money or time 消耗，花掉，耗费（尤指金钱或时间）【考研大纲词汇】

Those repair bills have really **eaten into** my savings.
那些修理账单已经耗掉我相当一部分积蓄。

aerospace n. /'eərəʊspeɪs/ [U] the industry of building aircraft and vehicles and equipment to be sent into space 航空航天（工业）；航空航天技术
jobs in **aerospace and defence** 航天与国防工作

happening n. /'hæpənɪŋ/ [usually pl.] an event; something that happens, often sth unusual 事件；发生的事情（常指不寻常的）【考研大纲词汇】

There have been strange **happenings** here lately.
这儿最近发生了一些怪事。

reinvent v. /'ri:m'vent/ ~ sth/yourself (as sth) to present yourself/sth in a new form or with a new image 以新形象示人；以新形式出现

The former wild man of rock has **reinvented** himself as a respectable family man.
过去的那位摇滚狂人已经改变形象，成了一位体面的爱家的男人。

了广泛关注，谷歌趋势数据显示，“Nothing Phone”和“Nothing耳机”的搜索量较过去五年均增长了500%。

【 Para.6 】

The company is a regular presence on TikTok, where users **gloat** about their choice of a non-Apple device. Nothing, itself, isn't shy about taking on the tech behemoth. “This is a message to Apple,” said CEO Carl Pei in a video posted to his TikTok account in June. “My name is Carl. I make phones in London. And I’m gonna steal your customers. One bored iPhone user at a time.””

该公司经常活跃在TikTok上，用户们在那里炫耀自己选择了非苹果设备。Nothing本身也不避讳挑战这家科技巨头。“这是给苹果的一封信，”首席执行官卡尔·佩伊（Carl Pei）在6月发布于其TikTok账号的一段视频中说道，“我叫卡尔。我在伦敦制造手机。我将抢走你们的客户。一次夺走一个厌倦了iPhone的用户。”

【 Para.7 】

In a fairly **commoditized** world of smartphones, Nothing has tried to stand out with at least one unusual feature: a **rear** display through which users can deliver notifications with various symbols and animations. The idea is to keep the phone **facedown**, limiting overall screen time.

在智能手机高度同质化的市场中，Nothing试图通过至少一项独特功能脱颖而出：后置显示屏，用户可通过该屏幕以各种符号和动画形式接收通知。这一设计旨在让手机保持屏幕朝下的状态，从而减少整体屏幕使用时间。

➤ 今日句子分析

主句	宾语从句
He believes	that the next consumertech winner will be
主语 谓语	从句主语 系语
an AI-powered wearable device	that can potentially
表语	从句主语 谓语
listen to	a person's day-to-day happenings, and
	宾语 (并列连词)
help with	anything
谓语	宾语
from scheduling appointments, messaging loved ones, or	
sending a reminder about picking up groceries on the	
way home after work.	
列举同位语	

句子分析：

主句：

主语-He；谓语-believes；

宾语从句：

（引导词）-that；从句主语-the next consumertech winner；系语-will be；表语-an AI-powered wearable device（名词+-powered“由……驱动的”）；

定语从句，修饰device：

从句主语-that；谓语-can potentially listen to；宾语-a person's day-to-day happenings（happening在这里是名词，需要注意）；（连词）-and；谓语-help with（这里可以补译为“协助处理”）；宾语-anything；

列举同位语-from scheduling appointments, messaging loved ones, or sending a reminder about picking up groceries on the way home after work（这三个并列的动名词都是对于anything的举例，用于凸显这类设备的功能之广）。

【 Para.8 】

Nothing has raised \$456 million, per PitchBook, including a Series C funding round that brought in \$200 million last year, giving the company a valuation of \$1.3 billion. It's rare air for consumer tech firms. According to PitchBook, of more than 31,000 VC-funded consumertech companies, just 0.4% have generated a \$1 billion-plus exit. Even for those, it's often a tough **go**.

据PitchBook数据显示，Nothing已累计融资4.56亿美元，其中包括去年完成的2亿美元C轮融资，使该公司估值达到13亿美元。这对消费科技公司而言实属罕见。PitchBook数据显示，在3.1万多家获得风投资金的消费科技公司中，仅有0.4%实现了10亿美元以上的退出。即便是这些公司，发展之路也往往充满艰辛。

【 Para.9 】

Fitbit, the wearable fitness-tracking device firm founded in 2007, raised about \$66 million in VC funding before going public in 2015 with a \$4.1 billion market value. Six years later, the firm sold itself to Alphabet's Google for half that amount.

Fitbit是一家成立于2007年的可穿戴健身追踪设备公司，在2015年以41亿美元市值上市前，共筹集了约6600万美元的风险投资。六年后，该公司以半数价格被Alphabet旗下的谷歌收购。

【 Para.10 】

Meanwhile, this past week marked the end of a long **saga** for GoPro, the maker of cameras for outdoor enthusiasts founded in 2002. GoPro went public in

➤ 写作积累

Para.4 That history makes it all the more surprising that one of this year's hottest consumer tech start-ups is taking on the establishment with...a phone.

make it+形容词+that从句中，it是形式宾语，后面的that从句才是真正宾语。这种用法主要是为了平衡句子，因为that从句一般都比较长，更适合放在句尾，例：

We need to make it clear that it's not just change for change's sake. 我们需要阐明，这不仅仅是为了改变而改变。

该句中还需要注意all the + 比较级的用法，这个表达式会更强调“更加……”，与even more的作用相似。例如：

His achievement is remarkable; all the more so because he had no help at all. 他的成就是非同一般；由于他没有得到过任何帮助，更是不凡。

Para.6 Nothing, itself, isn't shy about taking on the tech behemoth. 这个句子中同样有强调，只不过是用itself这个反身代词来强调前面的主语Nothing，指“Nothing这家公司本身并不怯于……”，例如：The idea itself is not bad. 这个想法本身并不坏。

而be shy about在这里属于拟人修辞，这个短语一般用于指“羞于/害怕做某事”，常用于否定句，例：They are shy about asking for help. 他们不好意思求助。

但需要与be shy of sth区分，后者还可以表达“未达到……”，例：He died before Christmas, only a month shy of his 90th birthday. 他在圣诞节前去世了，仅差一个月就满90岁。

2014 with a market value of \$3 billion, just in time for the smartphone camera to begin **eating into** its sales. For months, GoPro shares have traded below \$1. On Tuesday, the company said it was being acquired by Starman Optical in a \$285 million deal that would expand the business into the “AI data center, government, defense, and **aerospace** markets.”

与此同时，上周标志着GoPro一段漫长历程的终结。这家成立于2002年的户外运动相机制造商于

2014年上市，当时市值为30亿美元，但恰逢智能手机摄像头开始蚕食其销售额。数月来，GoPro股价一直徘徊在1美元以下。周二，该公司宣布将被Starman Optical以2.85亿美元收购，此举将使业务拓展至“AI数据中心、政府、国防和航空航天市场”。

【 Para.11 】

Venture capitalists are nothing if not optimists, though. Mark Vena, CEO and principal analyst at SmartTechResearch, tells Barron's that VC investors are currently looking for the next big consumer hardware AI play. He believes that the next consumertech winner will be an AI-powered wearable device that can potentially listen to a person's day-to-day **happenings**, and help with anything from scheduling appointments, messaging loved ones, or sending a reminder about picking up groceries on the way home after work..

不过，风险投资家们始终是乐观主义者。SmartTechResearch的首席执行官兼首席分析师马克·维纳（Mark Vena）告诉《巴伦周刊》，风险投资家们目前正在寻找下一个消费级硬件AI领域的热门项目。他认为，下一款消费科技领域的赢家将是一款由人工智能驱动的可穿戴设备，它能

够倾听用户的日常生活点滴，并协助处理各种事务，包括安排约会、给亲人发消息，或是提醒用户下班回家路上顺便买买菜。

【 Para.12 】

The challenge for Nothing will be merging its plain hardware aesthetic—the inspiration for its brand name—with the complications and baggage of AI. According to an August study from the Pew Research Center, 55% of adults under age 30 now say they're more concerned than excited about AI.

Nothing面临的挑战在于，如何将其简约的硬件美学——这也是其品牌名称的灵感来源——与人工智能的复杂性和历史包袱相融合。根据皮尤研究中心（Pew Research Center）8月份的一项研究，目前55%的30岁以下成年人表示，他们对人工智能的担忧多于兴奋。

【 Para.13 】

Nothing is betting that audience just needs a different device. “For AI to reach its full potential, consumer hardware must **reinvent** itself,” the company says on its website.

Nothing押注于用户只是需要一款不同的设备。“要让人工智能充分发挥潜力，消费类硬件必须重塑自我，”该公司在其官网上表示。